

Proportions for `ggplot2`

from Doing LVC with R*

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There are two main ways to make graphs in R. The first is using the standard graphing capabilities of R. The second is using a much more sophisticated and customizable graphics package called `ggplot2`. Describing the ins and outs of the `ggplot2` package is beyond the scope of these instructions, but what these instructions can do is teach you how to organize your summary statistics in such a way that they are usable by `ggplot2`.

Why is there a separate section on preparing summary statistics for `ggplot2`? It is `ggplot2` expects summary statistics to be organized in a way that is non-intuitive to us as sociolinguists. When we represent summary statistics we usually represent them like cross-tabs, for example:

Table 1: Percentage of deleted (t, d) tokens by Age Group and Sex in Cape Breton English

	Female		Male		Total	
Age Group	n	% Deletion	n	% Deletion	n	% Deletion
Young	271	27	357	34	628	31
Middle	238	31	122	43	360	35
Old	150	29	51	47	201	33
Total	659	28	530	37	1,189	32

In the above table there are variables both as rows (here `Age.Group`) and columns (here `Sex`). If I was going to create a chart in *Excel* of summary statistics this is how I would naturally make it. This is how data is presented in manuscripts, it is also how it is presented in *Goldvarb*, and it is how it is presented to us by the `prop.table()` function. It is NOT how `ggplot2` wants your data to be organized. For `ggplot2` each variable has to exist in its own individual column — much closer to the organization of the `fTable()` or what is produced using `tidy` methods.

In order to create this kind of organization (if not using `tidy` methods) you need to “melt” the `prop.table()` using the function `melt()` in the package `reshape2`. You’ll do this in two steps. First you create a new object `td.prop`, which is the proportion table of the levels of `Dep.Var` for each level of `Age.Group` and `Sex`, just like the table above. Then you “melt” that table using the function `melt()`, and assign this new table to a new object `td.prop.melt`.

💡 Get the data first

If you don’t have the `td` data loaded in R, go back to Doing it all again, but `tidy`^a and run the code.

*https://lingmethodshub.github.io/content/R/lvc_r/

^ahttps://lingmethodshub.github.io/content/R/lvc_r/050_lvc.html

```
# Create object td.prop as proportion table of each level of Dep.Var for each level of Age.Group and S
td.prop <-prop.table(table(td$Age.Group, td$Sex, td$Dep.Var), margin=c(1,2))

# Melt td.prop
library(reshape2)
td.prop.melt <-melt(td.prop)

# View first six lines of td.prop.melt
head(td.prop.melt)
```

	Var1	Var2	Var3	value
1	Old	F	Deletion	0.2866667
2	Middle	F	Deletion	0.3067227
3	Young	F	Deletion	0.2656827
4	Old	M	Deletion	0.4705882
5	Middle	M	Deletion	0.4262295
6	Young	M	Deletion	0.3417367

This new melted table does not contain informative column names, so you add those as the third step.

```
# Create column names for td.prop.melt
colnames(td.prop.melt) <-c("Age.Group", "Sex", "Dep.Var", "Percent")
# View first six lines of td.prop.melt
head(td.prop.melt)
```

	Age.Group	Sex	Dep.Var	Percent
1	Old	F	Deletion	0.2866667
2	Middle	F	Deletion	0.3067227
3	Young	F	Deletion	0.2656827
4	Old	M	Deletion	0.4705882
5	Middle	M	Deletion	0.4262295
6	Young	M	Deletion	0.3417367

An alternative way to melt the columns is to save the proportion table as a new tab-delimited-text file. You might want to do this anyway, as having a separate file containing summary statistics may be useful to you. One use I have for tab-delimited-text file versions of my summary statistics is that they are much easier for copying and pasting. If you copy and paste from the R console window there is an inconsistent number of space characters between columns (e.g., above there are five space characters between **1** and **Young**, four between **2** and **Middle**, and five between **3** and **Old**). If you save that same table to a text file you can specify that you want each cell separated by a tab character instead.

```
# Create object td.prop as proportion table of each level of Dep.Var for each level of Age.Group and S
td.prop <-prop.table(table(td$Age.Group, td$Sex, td$Dep.Var), margin=c(1,2))

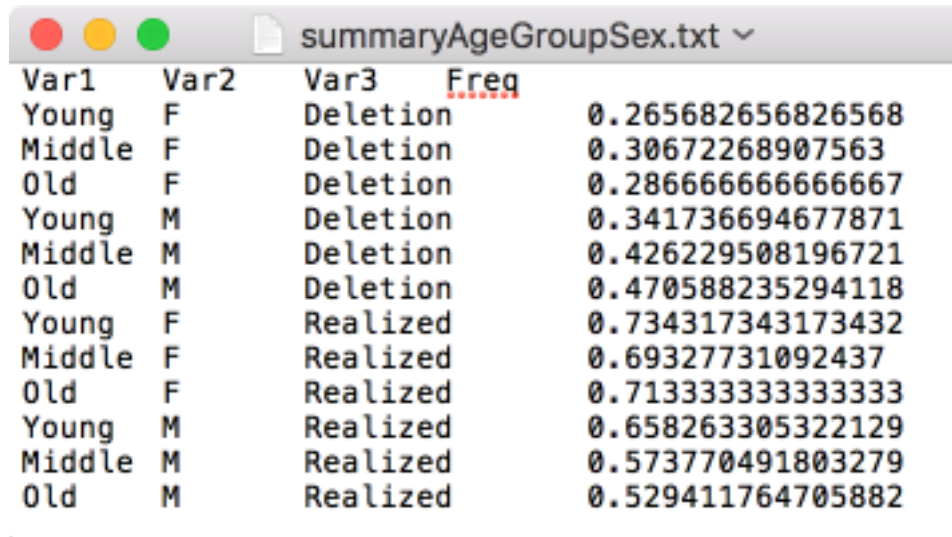
# Melt td.prop
library(reshape2)
td.prop.melt <-melt(td.prop)

# Create column names for td.prop.melt
colnames(td.prop.melt) <-c("Age.Group", "Sex", "Dep.Var", "Percent")

# Write td.prop.melt to file
write.table(td.prop.melt, file = "Data/summaryAgeGroupSexMelted.txt", quote = FALSE, sep = "\t", row.n
```

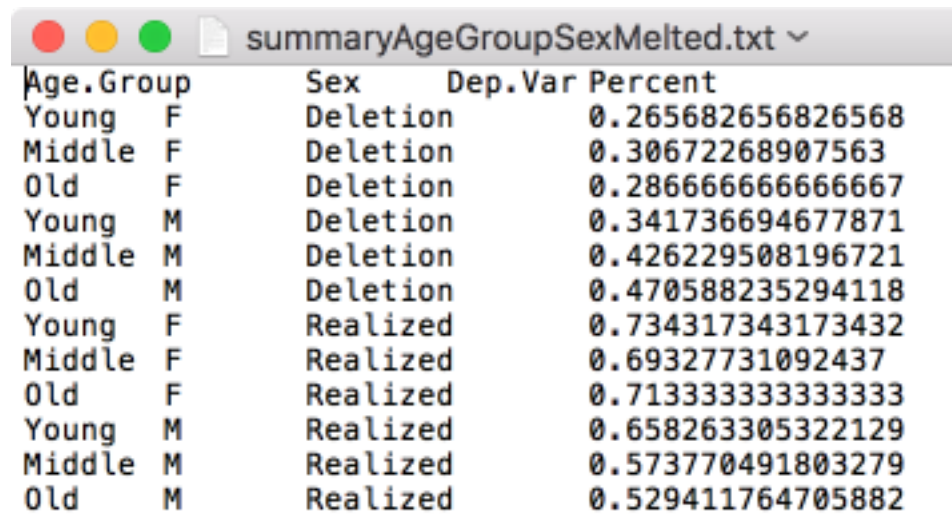
```
# Write td.prop to file (with automatic melting)
write.table(td.prop, file = "Data/summaryAgeGroupSex.txt", quote = FALSE, sep = "\t", row.names = FALSE)
```

The two `write.table()` functions above produce the exact same tab-delimited-text file. The one difference between them is that the melted table (e.g., `summaryAgeGroupSexMelted.txt`) includes column names.



Var1	Var2	Var3	Freq
Young	F	Deletion	0.265682656826568
Middle	F	Deletion	0.30672268907563
Old	F	Deletion	0.286666666666667
Young	M	Deletion	0.341736694677871
Middle	M	Deletion	0.426229508196721
Old	M	Deletion	0.470588235294118
Young	F	Realized	0.734317343173432
Middle	F	Realized	0.69327731092437
Old	F	Realized	0.713333333333333
Young	M	Realized	0.658263305322129
Middle	M	Realized	0.573770491803279
Old	M	Realized	0.529411764705882

Figure 1: Not Melted



Age.Group	Sex	Dep.Var	Percent
Young	F	Deletion	0.265682656826568
Middle	F	Deletion	0.30672268907563
Old	F	Deletion	0.286666666666667
Young	M	Deletion	0.341736694677871
Middle	M	Deletion	0.426229508196721
Old	M	Deletion	0.470588235294118
Young	F	Realized	0.734317343173432
Middle	F	Realized	0.69327731092437
Old	F	Realized	0.713333333333333
Young	M	Realized	0.658263305322129
Middle	M	Realized	0.573770491803279
Old	M	Realized	0.529411764705882

Figure 2: Melted

When the `write.table()` melts the proportion table for you it does not create the new column names. For this reason, I like to melt proportion tables before I save them so that I have the opportunity to name the table's columns. In the `write.table()` functions above you first specify the object you want to write to a text file, then you specify what you want to call that file and where you want it to be created. Here I've named the files `summaryAgeGroupSexMelted.txt` and `summaryAgeGroupSex.txt` and saved it in a subfolder called `Data` in the same folder in which my R script is saved. You can save your file anywhere on your computer and call it whatever you want. You can specify any file path here. For example, I could have

written `~/Documents/My Project/Data` to indicate a folder called `Data` in a folder called `My Project` in my `Documents` folder on root drive of my Mac computer. If you are running a PC your folder structure will likely start with `"C:/\dots"`. In the function you specify that `quote = FALSE`. If you specify `TRUE`, R will put quotation marks around the values in each cell. I have never needed this. You further specify that the separator between cells in the same row is a tab, `sep="\t"`, which creates a tab-delimited-text file (`.txt`). If you wanted to create a comma-separated-value table (`.csv`) you would instead specify `sep=","` and change the file extension from `".txt"` to `".csv"`. Finally, you specify that `row.names = FALSE` because there are no row names in this table, just column names.

If you've saved a summary statistics file previously and want to read it into R for use with `ggplot2`, you can use the same procedure as you used for reading in your data file.

```
# Read in Summary Statistics File
td.AgeSex <-read.delim("Data/summaryAgeGroupSexMelted.txt")
```

Here's an example of a basic `ggplot2` line graph that can be made with the above summary statistics. The first three steps are only necessary if you didn't read in the summary statistics file above.

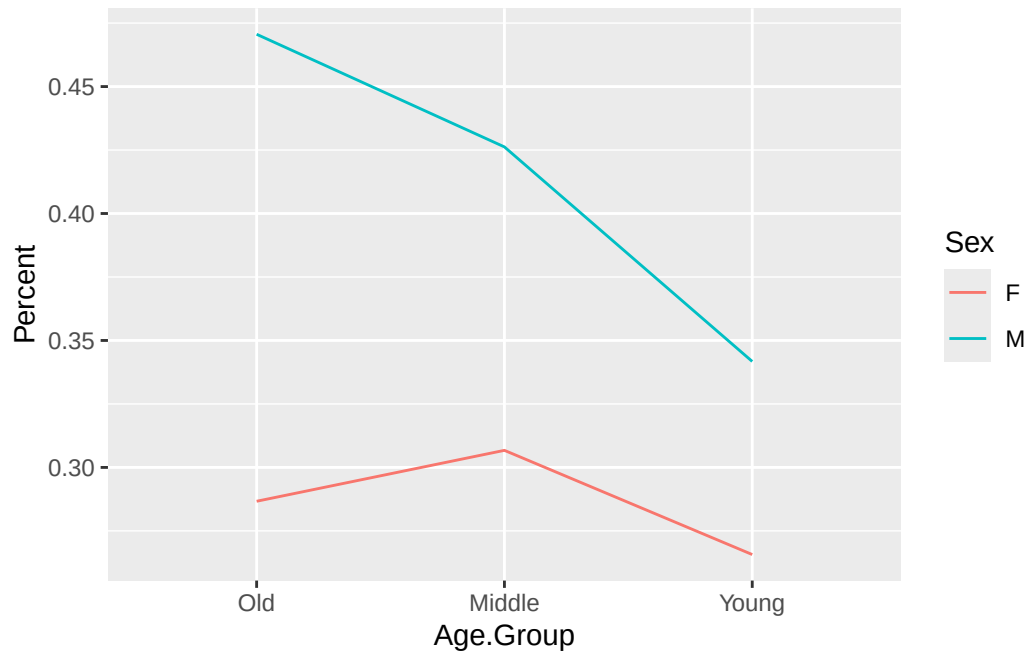
```
# Create object td.prop as proportion table of each level of Dep.Var
# for each level of Age.Group and Sex
td.prop <-prop.table(table(td$Age.Group, td$Sex, td$Dep.Var), margin=c(1,2))

# Melt td.prop
library(reshape2)
td.AgeSex <-melt(td.prop)

# Create column names for td.prop.melt
colnames(td.AgeSex) <-c("Age.Group", "Sex", "Dep.Var", "Percent")

# Reorder Age.Group
td.AgeSex$Age.Group <-factor(td.AgeSex$Age.Group, levels = c("Old", "Middle", "Young"))

# Create basic ggplot2 line graph of the proportion of deletion by Age.Group,
# with lines separated by Sex
library(ggplot2)
qplot(data = td.AgeSex[td.AgeSex$Dep.Var == "Deletion",],
      x = Age.Group,
      y = Percent,
      geom = "line",
      group = Sex,
      colour = Sex)
```



For this graph you can use the quick plot function `qplot()` available in the `ggplot2` package. For `qplot()` you specify the data, here the object `td.AgeSex` where `td.AgeSex`'s column `Dep.Var` equals `Deletion`. This filtering is only specified because you don't need to represent both `Deletion` and `Realization` on the same graph (as the value of one implies the value of the other). You then specify that you want your x-axis to be `Age.Group`: `x = Age.Group`. The axis will be ordered left to right (`Young`, `Middle`, `Old`) because you reordered the `Age.Group` column levels before running `qplot()`. You specify that `Percent` is the y-axis: `y = Percent`, and that the kind of graph you want is a line graph: `geom = "line"`. Specifying `group = Sex` means the data will be grouped according to the levels of `Sex`, and produces two lines in the graph: one for men and one for women. To make the two lines different colours, specify `colour = Sex`.¹

`ggplot2` is infinitely customizable. You can change almost every element of the graph — for example, you could change the y-axis to show 0 to 100 percent instead of 0 to 50 percent — but these types of specifications are for another set of instructions.²

The use of the `tidy` method for cross tabs should be immediately apparent. There is no need to take the extra step to melt your proportions before building your plot. We will use the same code that we used to generate proportions from the previous chapter³. First, it is useful to reorder the `Age.Group` variable, as this ordering will be inherited by the `summarize()` function. Next we use the `tidy` code to generate proportions and assign the results to an object called `results` and then build our plot from that object. We also make a tweak so that the y-axis ranges from 0 to 1, as this is the full range of possible proportions with `ylim=c(0,1)`.⁴ This also moderates what might look like extreme differences in the figure generated above with a smaller y-axis. We also give the x-axis and the y-axis new labels with `ylab="Proportion of Deleted Tokens"` and `xlab= "Age Group"` and give the table a title with `main = "Proportion of Deleted (t ,d) tokens in Cape Breton English by Age and Sex"`.

```
# Reorder Age.Group
td.AgeSex$Age.Group <- factor(td.AgeSex$Age.Group, levels = c("Old", "Middle", "Young"))

# Generate a tidy object of proportions of Dep.Var
# by Age.Group and Sex, with only Deletion included
```

¹Or `color = Sex`. Both will work.

²There are lots of `ggplot2` instructions online. Searching “change y-axis, qplot, ggplot2” will likely find you the right information.

³https://lingmethodshub.github.io/content/R/lvc_r/060_lvc.html

⁴The concatenating function `c()` is used to combine values. Here it combines the desired start and end of the y-axis.

```
results <- td %>%
  group_by(Age.Group, Sex, Dep.Var, .drop = FALSE) %>%
  summarize(Count = n()) %>%
  mutate(Prop = Count/sum(Count)) %>%
  subset(Dep.Var == "Deletion")

# Create basic ggplot2 line graph of the proportion of deletion
# by Age.Group, with lines separated by Sex
library(ggplot2)
qplot(data = results,
      x = Age.Group,
      y = Prop,
      geom = "line",
      group = Sex,
      colour = Sex,
      ylim = c(0,1),
      ylab = "Proportion of Deleted Tokens",
      xlab = "Age Group",
      main = "Proportion of Deleted (t ,d) tokens in Cape Breton English\nby Age and Sex")
```

Proportion of Deleted (t ,d) tokens in Cape Breton English
by Age and Sex

